

view of a particular area at the same time.

With 360-degree surveillance cameras, that is not the case. 360-degree cameras use a fish-eye lens to capture an all-round view of the field under surveillance. Thus these cameras can substantially bring down the expense incurred on surveillance, as enterprises would require fewer number of cameras to be installed over an area. For instance, if an area within the office premises required two PTZ cameras to get a full view of

interactive as they break the monotony of flat, plain-vanilla videos. Besides, 360-degree videos offer a real-time experience to trainees, giving them a better understanding of the subject under discussion. These videos are also considered to be cost-efficient as they eliminate the need for an in-person trainer.

Use of 360-degree videos for corporate training is best suited to large-scale enterprises that often organise training sessions for their employees across the country or overseas.

set up a full-fledged infrastructure that includes building and staff among others. Their trained doctors can do the job through 360-degree videos.

Enhance brand value

Let's go back to Facebook's *Treasure Hunt* campaign that used 360-degree videos to engage with customers for their annual *Big Billion Day* sales. The campaign managed to increase the retailer's Instagram user base by a whopping 350 per cent while it garnered nearly 750,000 views and over 21,000 comments within the first two days itself. Other brands too have tried the immersive video technology and achieved success in their initiatives.

Better customer connect

Companies can use 360-degree videos for their products on display online, giving customers a virtual touch-and-feel experience. This helps not only give customers a better understanding of the product but also win their trust. This is especially true in the case of high-value items such as diamonds and smartphones.

Similarly, companies that need to invest in large distributor networks for their products can use this technology to help customers select the best option. For instance, auto companies are increasingly suggesting their dealer networks to install 360-degree cameras in their stores in order to ensure that best facilities and services are offered to their customers.

Is 360 degree the way ahead?

Definitely. Any technology that helps enterprises enhance their business is here to stay. So if you belong to the old school of tried-and-tested ideology, you may just be missing out on a great opportunity to scale up your revenues. **BY**

—Purba Das



A 360-degree camera being used for surveillance (Image courtesy: YouTube)

the area, it would now require only one panoramic camera for monitoring the entire area.

These cameras are especially useful for logistics, retail, entertainment and other such enterprises that see movements of a large number of goods and people.

Corporate training

While use of 360-degree videos or immersive videos is not new, corporates are exploiting their potential in other applications too. One such application is corporate training.

According to experts, corporate trainings imparted using immersive videos turn out to be far more

Reduce cost of investment

For healthcare sector, 360-degree videos are a definite boon. In a country such as India where people cannot avail even the basic medical care, 360-degree videos can help healthcare providers save many lives as services become cost-efficient. For instance, in a tier 2 or tier 3 city, a hospital chain need not set up an entire hospital but rather partner with a local hospital, provide it with the requisite equipment and train as well as supervise local doctors to diagnose and even carry out surgeries. Thus, for hospital chains, 360-degree videos completely eliminate the need to